# Talk About Who Would Help Mom Before Anyone Has To

Map who could be involved, separate real commitments from good intentions, give distant relatives something concrete, and name who holds the plan.

## Where you are

Mom is managing fine, and the family has started saying things like 'we'll all pitch in when the time comes.' Nobody has said what that means, who lives close enough to do what, or who would keep track of it all. You have time to find out.

This guide gives you four ChatGPT prompts to organize what you already know and to see what you don't know yet. It is preparation, not an assessment. Use only information you have permission to share, with names removed. The AI organizes and drafts; it does not diagnose, assess safety, or decide. Bring clinical questions to a clinician, and call emergency services for an emergency.

## What you'll have at the end

You can describe who in the family could realistically take which role, what has actually been promised, and who would hold the plan until it's needed.

**A one-page provisional care team map: People Who Could Be Involved, Confirmed Commitments, Offers Not Yet Confirmed, Roles Nobody Has Claimed, and Who Keeps This Current.**

## Before you start

- A list of family members and roughly where each one lives.
- Anything Mom has said about who she'd want involved.
- Notes from any family conversation about the future, even a short one. Two of these are plenty to begin.

PROMPT 1

## Map who could be involved, honestly

### WHY THIS MATTERS

Families picture the future team as 'all of us.' Written down, it is usually three people within an hour's drive and four who love her from far away. Both groups matter, but they can't do the same things.

### WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Family names, where they live, their work and family situations as you understand them, and what Mom has said about who she'd want.

### COPY THIS PROMPT

> My mother is well right now, and I'm trying to understand who in the family could be part of her care team if she needed more help someday. Here is who I'm thinking of, where each one lives,

> and what I know about their situations:
>
> [PASTE YOUR NOTES]
>
> Here is what my mother has said about who she'd want involved:
>
> [PASTE HER COMMENTS, OR WRITE 'NOT DISCUSSED YET']
>
> Organize this into a table: PERSON, DISTANCE FROM HER, LIKELY CONSTRAINTS, and WHAT SHE HAS SAID ABOUT THEM. Add a row for the professionals we would probably need, with the roles left blank. Don't suggest who should do what yet.

#### WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Who is actually near, who isn't, and whether Mom's wishes have been asked at all.

#### WHAT TO DO NEXT

If the second placeholder said 'not discussed yet,' that conversation with Mom is the next thing.

PROMPT 2

## Separate what's promised from what's possible

#### WHY THIS MATTERS

'Of course I'll help' is kind, and it isn't a plan. The useful question is what, specifically, and whether that still fits when someone has a full-time job and two kids.

#### WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Anything family members have said about helping, in their words where you can remember them.

#### COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here are things my family members have said about helping my mother in the future, as close to their words as I can remember:
>
> [PASTE WHAT PEOPLE HAVE SAID]
>
> Sort each statement into one of three columns: CONFIRMED COMMITMENT (a specific task they clearly agreed to), GENERAL OFFER (willing but vague), and ASSUMED BY OTHERS (something the family expects of them that they haven't said themselves). For each general offer, write one short question I could ask that person to turn it into something specific. Keep the questions friendly and give people room to say no.

#### WHAT TO LOOK FOR

How much of the plan sits in the third column. That's the part that will fail first.

#### WHAT TO DO NEXT

Send one of the questions to one person this week. Just one.

PROMPT 3

## Give far-away family something real to carry

#### WHY THIS MATTERS

Distance is the most common reason everything lands on the sibling nearby. The nearby sibling resents it, the distant one feels useless, and both are right. There is plenty of coordination work a phone can do.

#### WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The table from prompt 1 and the columns from prompt 2.

#### COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is my mother's possible future care team, where people live, and what they've offered so far:
>
> [PASTE THE RESULTS OF PROMPTS 1 AND 2]
>
> List the kinds of tasks a future care arrangement usually involves, grouped as NEEDS SOMEONE NEARBY (rides, visits, being there in person), CAN BE DONE FROM ANYWHERE (calls, scheduling, paperwork, research, bill tracking), and NEEDS A PROFESSIONAL (medical, legal, or financial questions). Then, for the family members who live far away, list the from-anywhere tasks their situations might suit. Mark these as ideas to ask them about, not assignments. Do not fill the professional group with advice; just name the kind of professional.

#### WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A real list of jobs for the people who said 'I wish I could do more.'

#### WHAT TO DO NEXT

Share the from-anywhere list with one distant relative and ask what they'd be open to.

PROMPT 4

## Put it on one page and name who keeps it current

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

A plan nobody maintains is wrong by the time you need it. One person should hold it, and one person should be able to take over if they can't.

**WHAT YOU'LL NEED**

Everything from the first three prompts.

**COPY THIS PROMPT**

> Here is everything I've gathered about who might help my mother in the future:
>
> [PASTE THE RESULTS OF PROMPTS 1 TO 3]
>
> Turn this into a one-page provisional care team map with five headings: PEOPLE WHO COULD BE INVOLVED, CONFIRMED COMMITMENTS, OFFERS NOT YET CONFIRMED, ROLES NOBODY HAS CLAIMED, and WHO KEEPS THIS CURRENT. Under the last heading, leave two blank lines labeled 'keeper' and 'backup keeper' for me to fill in after I ask. Under roles nobody has claimed, include coordination of the whole plan if no one has taken it. Add a line at the bottom for when we agreed to look at this again. Mark anything about who would make medical or legal decisions for her as 'to be clarified with the right professional.'

**WHAT TO LOOK FOR**

A page you could send to the whole family without anyone feeling assigned to something they didn't agree to.

**WHAT TO DO NEXT**

Ask one person to be the keeper, then move on to the step below with the map in hand.

### Give the future team one file to start from

When the time comes, every person on this map will need the same understanding of Mom's situation. The care interview builds that understanding now, area by area, into a Family Care Profile the family can keep current together.

**Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›**